

Information Security Handbook

Version 1.4 | Synthetic sample for retrieval testing

Document owner	Information Security
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Review cycle	Every 12 months
Classification	Internal - sample

This is a fictional document created for software testing. Names, email addresses, limits, and procedures are synthetic.

PURPOSE AND RESPONSIBILITIES

This handbook defines the minimum security requirements for employees and contractors who access company systems or handle company information.

Every user is responsible for protecting credentials, devices, and data. Suspected security events must be reported even when the user is uncertain that an incident occurred.

IDENTITY AND ACCESS

- Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for email, source control, cloud consoles, and remote access.
- Passwords must contain at least 14 characters.
- Routine password rotation is not required. A password must be changed immediately if compromise is suspected or confirmed.
- Accounts are personal and must never be shared.
- Access rights are reviewed every 90 days by the system owner.

Never approve an unexpected multi-factor authentication request.

SECURITY INCIDENT REPORTING

A suspected phishing message, accidental data disclosure, malware alert, or unauthorized account activity must be reported to security@example.test within 30 minutes of discovery.

A lost or stolen company device must be reported to both the service desk and security team within 1 hour. The report should include the device type, last known location, and approximate time of loss.

- Do not delete suspicious messages before the security team reviews them.
- Do not contact a suspected attacker.
- Preserve screenshots, timestamps, and relevant error messages.
- Call the emergency security number when email or chat is unavailable.

DEVICE AND SOFTWARE REQUIREMENTS

Company laptops must use full-disk encryption, automatic screen locking after 10 minutes, and centrally managed endpoint protection.

Operating-system and browser security updates must be installed within 7 calendar days of release. Critical patches may be required within 24 hours.

- Only software from the approved catalogue may be installed.
- Local administrator access is granted only for a documented business need and expires after 30 days unless renewed.
- USB storage is blocked by default and requires a security exception.

EQUIPMENT LIFECYCLE

Equipment	Standard replacement cycle	Return requirement
Laptop	4 years	Return within 5 business days of replacement
Monitor	5 years	Return when requested by IT
Mobile phone	3 years	Return before a replacement is issued
Security key	As needed	Return at end of employment

REMOTE WORK AND PUBLIC NETWORKS

Remote access to internal systems must use the company VPN. Public Wi-Fi may be used only when the VPN is active. Highly confidential information must not be viewed where unauthorized people can see the screen.

Company devices must not be left unattended in a vehicle overnight. During travel, devices must remain in carry-on luggage.

DATA CLASSIFICATION AND RETENTION

Information is classified as Public, Internal, Confidential, or Highly Confidential. Confidential and Highly Confidential information must be encrypted in transit and at rest.

Customer support records are retained for 3 years after case closure. Security audit logs are retained for 13 months. Legal holds override normal deletion schedules.

BACKUP AND RECOVERY

Production databases are backed up every 6 hours. Backup copies are encrypted and retained for 35 days. A restoration test is performed every quarter.

Files stored only on a laptop desktop or local downloads folder are not centrally backed up.

CONTACT

Policy questions should be sent to the fictional mailbox security-governance@example.test.